IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 27, 2026

Pivotal Week

Iran talks stall as oil firms; FOMC, GDP, PCE, and five Mag7 prints converge into a defining week for the AI tape.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	BRENT (LIVE)	BITCOIN (LIVE)	AMD (FRI CLOSE)	FEAR & GREED
~7,139 · New ATH	~$107 · Firming	~$77,800 · Holding bid	$347.81 ↑13.91%	31 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets

RECORDS INTO A WALL OF CATALYSTS — FIVE MAG7 PRINTS, FOMC, GDP, AND PCE IN FIVE SESSIONS

Friday closed at fresh all-time highs on the back of Intel's blowout print, with the S&P 500 gaining 0.77% to roughly 7,139 and the Nasdaq surging 1.91%. The semiconductor sleeve carried the tape: AMD surged 13.91% to $347.81, QCOM jumped 11.12% to $148.85 ahead of Wednesday's earnings, TSM added 5.17%, and IOWN's recent additions CRDO (+5.12%) and VST (+4.78%) contributed materially. The Dow lagged at −0.16% as defense and healthcare rotated lower, with LMT dropping 3.08% and SSNC falling 3.95%. Overnight, S&P futures sit roughly flat into the heaviest catalyst week of the quarter: the FOMC convenes April 28–29 with no cut priced (Polymarket implies 99.9% hold per CME FedWatch), Microsoft, Alphabet, Meta, and Amazon report Wednesday after close, Apple Thursday, QCOM Wednesday, and the BEA delivers Q1 advance GDP and March PCE on Thursday. The committee should expect the AI-capex narrative to be repriced once hyperscaler capital expenditure guidance arrives.

POWELL'S PROBE DROPPED FRIDAY — WARSH CONFIRMATION PATH NOW OPEN

The DOJ closed its criminal probe of Fed Chair Powell on Friday afternoon, per CNBC and Al Jazeera coverage citing US Attorney for DC Jeannine Pirro, removing the procedural barrier that had blocked Kevin Warsh's confirmation. Senator Tillis had conditioned his vote on closure of the investigation. With Powell's term as Chair expiring May 15, the Senate now has a clear runway to confirm Warsh ahead of that date. The transition matters for IOWN's rate-sensitive positioning: Warsh has historically been associated with a more hawkish posture on inflation expectations than the current FOMC consensus. The April 28–29 meeting will be Powell's penultimate as Chair, and the press conference is likely to be parsed for any signal on the succession framework. JPMorgan Research and Morgan Stanley both sit at hold-through-2026 on the rate path, with the first cut now priced toward late 2026 per recent Reuters polling.

QCOM SETS UP AS THE WEEK'S FIRST IOWN EARNINGS CATALYST — AI OPTIONALITY IN FOCUS

QCOM reports Wednesday after close, the first material IOWN print of the week. Friday's 11.12% rally to $148.85 reflected positioning into the result rather than fundamental confirmation. SeekingAlpha's Q2 preview framed AI optionality as the central earnings narrative, with the data center accelerator roadmap and on-device AI handset attach rates the two metrics that could re-rate the multiple. The Barclays Underweight thesis, anchored on Apple modem-insourcing risk and a 2027 royalty cliff, is the cleanest counter-point. The

stock has now retraced a meaningful portion of its post-March drawdown, and the pre-earnings setup carries elevated implied volatility into the print. NXPI reports Tuesday, OKE Wednesday, PCAR Tuesday morning, and CWAN reports May 7. The earnings sequence is dense and will likely set the tone for the dividend sleeve's Q2 trajectory.

S&P 500 (FRI)	~7,139 · ↑0.77% · Fresh ATH on Intel ripple
AMD / QCOM	AMD ↑13.91% · QCOM ↑11.12% into Wed earnings
FOMC	April 28–29 · Hold priced 99.9% (Polymarket)
POWELL PROBE	DOJ closed Friday · Warsh confirmation path open
MAG7 EARNINGS	MSFT/GOOGL/META/AMZN Wed · AAPL Thu
IOWN REPORTS	QCOM Wed · NXPI Tue · OKE Wed · PCAR Tue

A tape that closes at all-time highs into a five-session window containing the FOMC, five Mag7 prints, Q1 GDP, and March PCE is telling the committee that positioning has compressed against the catalyst stack. The dispersion between hyperscaler capex guidance and energy-inflation prints will define the rotation. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

IRAN TALKS STALLED OVER THE WEEKEND — TRUMP HALTED DISCUSSIONS, PEZESHKIAN REJECTED "IMPOSED NEGOTIATIONS"

The 3–5 day engagement window from the April 21 ceasefire extension closed without resolution. Per Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and CBS News coverage, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi briefly visited Islamabad on Sunday as Pakistani mediators worked to revive talks, but Trump cancelled the planned US envoy trip and stated the sides could speak by phone instead. Iranian President Pezeshkian publicly rejected the framework, characterizing the US posture as coercive and conditional on the lifting of the naval blockade. The structural impasse remains unchanged: Iran insists the US naval blockade on Iranian ports be lifted before substantive nuclear talks resume, while Trump has tied the pause on US strikes to the full reopening of Hormuz transit. A senior Iranian official stated over the weekend that Hormuz transit will not return to its prior state under any circumstances. The conflict has now entered its ninth week, with the IEA continuing to characterize the disruption as the largest energy supply shock on record.

OIL FIRMED OVERNIGHT ON THE HORMUZ STANDOFF — BRENT BACK TOWARD $107

Brent crude rose toward $107 per barrel overnight, recouping a portion of last week's drift lower as the diplomatic track stalled. WTI traded near $96 per barrel, per CNBC and Bloomberg coverage. The move reverses the late-week compression of the war premium and reinforces the higher-for-longer commodity inflation thesis underlying the Fed's hold posture. The IOWN energy sleeve carries the structural exposure: VLO closed Friday at $235.85 (+0.86%), CVX at $185.21 (–1.27%), CTRA at $33.53 (–0.36%), and OKE at $87.50 (+0.33%). Refining margins remain elevated relative to pre-conflict baselines per Morgan Stanley research, supporting the VLO and OKE thesis. The dispersion between energy inflation and disinflationary tech earnings will be the principal cross-current the committee should track this week, particularly as it intersects with Thursday's March PCE print.

IRAN TALKS	Stalled · Trump cancelled envoy trip · Phone-only proposed
PEZESHKIAN	Rejected coercive framework · Blockade must lift first
HORMUZ	No return to prior state · Per Iranian official
BRENT / WTI	~$107 · ~$96 · War premium re-firming
CONFLICT DURATION	Week 9 · IEA — largest energy supply shock on record

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. FOMC convenes Tuesday–Wednesday with Powell's succession in the press-conference subtext. No move is priced and JPMorgan now expects rates to hold through the remainder of 2026. The market-moving content will be the dot-plot framing of the energy-inflation pass-through and any signal on the Powell-to-Warsh transition mechanics. With the DOJ probe closed Friday, Warsh's confirmation timeline has compressed materially. The committee should watch the long end: TLT closed Friday at $86.71, and any hawkish Warsh-tilt language in the press conference could pressure duration. The rate-sensitive dividend names — ATO, NEE, BKH, EIX — absorbed Thursday's Morgan Stanley target trim and rallied Friday on the broader risk-on tape. The pair-trade exposure remains live. *Avoid Erosion.*

2. Five Mag7 prints Wednesday and Thursday will reset the AI-capex narrative for the IOWN semiconductor sleeve. MSFT (Wednesday after close, $4.07 EPS consensus on $81.4B revenue per Yahoo Finance), GOOGL ($2.67 EPS), META ($6.64 EPS on $55.6B), AMZN ($1.65 EPS on $177.2B), and AAPL Thursday ($1.95 EPS) will collectively define the hyperscaler capital expenditure posture for the second half. The read-across to NVDA, AMD, TSM, MRVL, CRDO, KEYS, and LRCX is direct: any deceleration in stated capex would compress the AI-tape multiple, while an upside surprise would extend the rally that Intel's Q1 print catalyzed. Each of the four Wednesday reporters has rallied more than 10% in April per Yahoo Finance — positioning has tightened materially. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. QCOM reports Wednesday after close — the first major IOWN print of the week. The Friday rally of 11.12% to $148.85 reflects positioning into AI-edge optionality rather than fundamental confirmation. Watch the data-center accelerator commentary and on-device AI handset attach metrics — both could re-rate the multiple if confirmed. The Barclays Underweight thesis (Apple modem-insourcing, 2027 royalty cliff) is the cleanest counter-point. NXPI reports Tuesday and PCAR reports Tuesday morning — both names are exposed to industrial and auto end-markets that have been resilient through the conflict cycle. OKE Wednesday rounds out the IOWN earnings sequence ahead of Thursday's macro prints. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

4. Q1 advance GDP and March PCE both print Thursday at 8:30 AM ET. The Atlanta Fed GDPNow nowcast sits at 1.2% as of April 21, while the New York Fed nowcast was at 2.4% as of April 24 — a wide bank dispersion that suggests material uncertainty in the Q1 print. The PCE release is the more market-relevant of the two: February core PCE printed 3.0% year-over-year per the BEA, and any acceleration in March would harden the Fed's hold posture into the May meeting and reinforce the energy-inflation pass-through story. A softer print could re-open the late-2026 cut path. The release is consequential for the long end of the curve and for the duration-sensitive sub-sleeves. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

5. Bitcoin held a constructive bid through the weekend — IBIT options open interest now leads Deribit. Bitcoin traded near $77,800 Sunday evening with intraweek highs near $79,400 per Coinbase data. Spot Bitcoin ETF inflows extended a fourth consecutive week of net positive flows at roughly $824 million for the week of April 20–24 per CryptoTimes, with IBIT capturing approximately $733 million. IBIT options open interest reached $27.61 billion Friday on Nasdaq, surpassing Deribit's $26.90 billion per public exchange data — a notable inflection in the regulated-versus-offshore derivatives landscape. The structural-flow thesis behind IBIT and ETHA continues to strengthen even as spot price consolidates below recent highs. *The physical world matters.*

6. The Hormuz blockade-versus-talks impasse defines the week's tail risk. Trump cancelled the US envoy trip Sunday after Iranian Foreign Minister Araghchi's brief Islamabad visit failed to produce engagement terms. With Pezeshkian publicly rejecting the current framework, the binary path narrows: either Iran accepts a phone-channel framework that allows the US blockade to remain in place during talks, or the conflict re-escalates kinetically. A weekend escalation event — new Hormuz seizures, kinetic action, or a formal talks collapse — would gap oil higher and pressure the AI-tape multiple ahead of the FOMC. The energy sleeve (VLO, CVX, CTRA, OKE) and the precious-metals exposure (AEM, GLD-correlated names) carry the hedge weight. **Think Like an Owner.**

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